



Story Time talk card

Booker Tries Again · Book 1 · read it free on the Futures at Home page, Story Time

Booker Tries Again

Say-along line: Big breath. Brave heart. I can try again!

Hand on your chest for "big breath," a fist over your heart for "brave heart," thumbs up for "try again."



Talk about it

1. How did Booker feel when he said "cat" and it was not right? What did his ears do?
2. What helped Booker figure out the word? (Look at the picture, say the first sound, slide through the sounds, try again.)
3. Lumi said, "Hard things are just new things." What is something new you are learning?
4. Let's say Booker's brave words together. When could you use them?

Words to talk about

flap: a little paper door in a book that you lift to see what is under it

word: letters together that say something

softly: in a quiet, gentle voice

brand-new: so new that nobody has used it yet

drooped: hung down low, like a tired flower

clue: a little hint that helps you figure something out

Try it together: Brave Reader Steps (5 minutes)

You need: Three scraps of paper; A crayon or marker

1. Draw a simple sun, cat and kite, one on each paper, and write the word under each picture: SUN, CAT, KITE.
2. Hold up the KITE card. Ask, "What would Booker do first?" (Look at the picture.) Make paw binoculars.
3. Point to the first letter and say its sound together. Tap your lips as you say it.
4. Slide a finger slowly under the word while your child slides a hand down their arm. Read the word together, then do the brave cheer.
5. Try SUN and CAT. Then let your child "be Booker" and lead the steps for you.

Take it home: When something feels hard tonight, take a big breath together and say Booker's words: "Big breath. Brave heart. I can try again!"



Story Time talk card

Big Feelings, Brighter Days · Book 2 · read it free on the Futures at Home page, Story Time

Big Feelings, Brighter Days

Say-along line: Look. Listen. Lend a hand.

Point to your eyes for "look," cup your ears for "listen," and hold out an open hand for "lend a hand."



Talk about it

1. How could Lumi tell that Pip felt lonely? What did Pip's body show?
2. What did Lumi do when her own tummy felt wobbly and worried? Let's smell the flower and blow the candle together.
3. What words did Lumi use to invite Pip to play?
4. Who could you invite to play with you tomorrow?

Words to talk about

notices: sees something and pays attention to it

alone: by yourself, with nobody else

lonely: when you want a friend, but you don't have one yet

parade: a line of friends marching and making music

sigh: a long, slow breath out when you feel sad or tired

wobbly: shaky, not steady

Try it together: Feeling Faces and Flower Breaths (5 minutes)

You need: A mirror, if you have one; A real flower, a paper flower or just your finger

1. Make five faces together in the mirror: happy, lonely, worried, calm and proud. Say each feeling word.
2. Ask, "Which face did Pip have by the fence?" (Lonely.) "Which face did Lumi have at the end?" (Proud.)
3. Hold up the flower. Do three flower-and-candle breaths together: smell the flower, blow the candle.
4. Practice inviting: your child says, "Do you want to play with me?" and you answer, "Yes!" Then swap.
5. Finish with the hand motions: "Look. Listen. Lend a hand. Kindness brightens every day!"

Take it home: At bedtime, ask, "How did you feel today?" Then smell the flower and blow the candle together three times.



Story Time talk card

What Happens If We Try? · Book 3 · read it free on the Futures at Home page, Story Time

What Happens If We Try?

Say-along line: I wonder, I wonder... what happens if we try?

Tap your chin for "I wonder, I wonder," then open both hands wide for "what happens if we try?"



Talk about it

1. What happened to the ice cube on the porch?
2. Where did the ice melt fastest? Where did it melt slowest? Why do you think so?
3. How did Zuri turn water back into ice?
4. What do you wonder about? How could we try it and find out?

Words to talk about

compass: a tool that shows you which way to go

porch: a covered spot outside the front door

maybe: it might be true, but we are not sure yet

ice: water that got so cold it turned hard

puddle: a little pool of water on the ground

wonder: think about something and want to find out

Try it together: Ice Detectives (5 minutes)

You need: Three ice cubes, as big as you can make them; Three small plates; A paper towel or a mitten

1. Put one plate in a sunny spot and one in a shady spot. Your child holds the third cube in a paper towel or a mitten.
2. Ask, "Which one will melt first?" Let your child point to their guess, and make your own guess too.
3. Watch for 3 minutes. Take turns saying what you notice: drips, smaller, puddle, still big.
4. Say Zuri's finding together: "Warm makes ice melt. Cold makes water freeze."
5. Check the plates again later and talk about what changed.

Take it home: Put an ice cube on a plate at home and ask your child, "Where do you think it will melt faster?" Then try it and find out together.